



Jagdeep Dangi firmly believes in the need for a browser in the language of the masses

When we asked him how he went about the formidable task of building a Web browser, he replied, "I wanted to bridge languages, and so read many text books and magazines, and used the Internet to learn programming languages. Then I just worked day and night on my PC until I could convert my ideas into code."

A humble and concise description for three years spent on voracious and dedicated reading and learning, of toiling day and night, of clattering away at his keyboard. Then again, Dangi is humility personified, and speaking to him we could almost hear the movie narrator's voice boom, "...all-round good guy." Complete with a healthy family.

There's mom and dad and five sons—Dangi at 26 is the youngest, the baby of the lot. The fact that he's pampered is evident. He happily admits, "I am the favourite of the five children. My parents and brothers have always supported me and my work." His father and his three eldest brothers are farmers; the fourth brother is an advocate.

We asked him if anyone helped him with the coding—friends, professors, etc. "No," he replied simply. Then we wondered how much of a hurdle English posed to him, and how he managed to cope. He replied, "I studied in a Hindi-medium school till Class 12. English became a problem when I started my computer engineering degree. My English was very poor, but thankfully my strengths are logic and mathematics, and I managed to succeed using the subjects that required them. I do still face problems trying to express myself in English."

Jagdeep is currently unemployed, after a marathon-run of coding. He is awaiting a patent for his browser, and wants to market it to earn some money to support his future projects. "My browser offers all the functionalities of

“Today, everything of importance is on the Internet... This browser will also be useful to many governments' rural IT education programs.

Jagdeep Dangi



Write In

Assembled something just as geeky? Tell us about it. Write to editor@thinkdigit.com

Microsoft's Internet Explorer, with all menus and commands in the Devanagari script," says Dangi. Perhaps the most exciting feature is the browser's translation tool—with a mouse-click, you can translate any word displayed in the browser, or within any Windows application, into Hindi—with even the short pronunciation keys that we are used to seeing at Dictionary.com. What's more, the software even throws a list of synonyms: where did he source the database? True to his style, Dangi spent meticulous hours scouring textbooks, dictionaries, and newspapers to build the software database, word by word, meaning by meaning.

Other Feats

The browser is his most renowned exploit, but is in no way his only creation. "I have also created other software, such as my Saral Hindi Editor, English-Hindi-English Digital Dictionary, and the Global Word Translator. Currently I am working on a full-page translation program. I have succeeded logically in the code, but need to desperately improve grammatically. If I could get help from an English Guru, I could complete it soon." Any volunteers?

What about Linux? And his dream of a Hindi operating system? "I would love to, but I just do not have the requisite facilities. I only want to market my products to make enough money to work on more applications, including my idea of a Hindi OS."

The Man

So what does Dangi do when he isn't coding? "Books are my best friends, and my guru is my God. My favourite books are the *Geeta-Gyaan* and *Premchand Ki Kahaniyan*, My favourite movie is *Koi Mil Gaya*, and I love old songs by Mukesh."

Most importantly, Dangi's spirit is unbreakable. He does not use his disabilities as a crutch, as most others would try and do. He lost the use of his legs when he was young. To make matters worse, an adverse reaction to medicines injected by doctors in Bhopal while treating his legs, caused him to go blind in one eye. The allergic reaction may have given Jagdeep a close shave with death, but it only reinforced his parents' belief that he was "a gift from God".

Physically and visually challenged, hailing from the heart of rural India, Jagdeep Dangi's achievements are an inspiration. When we asked about what he wants to do, he said, "I want to work for the government, in the area of software research and development. But I don't have enough money or political contacts to get a job like that!" We hope someone who does is reading this! ☒

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Buzzword
of the MONTH

DomainKeys

One of the prominent anti-spam solutions is DomainKeys, developed by Yahoo!. A hash of an e-mail is encrypted along with the mail server's private key, encoded, appended to the message as a

mail header field, and transmitted along with the mail. A system can request the mail server's public key from a DNS server, decrypt the hash and compare it against the text of the e-mail. The local mail client can decide what to do with the e-mail based on the outcome of this comparison.